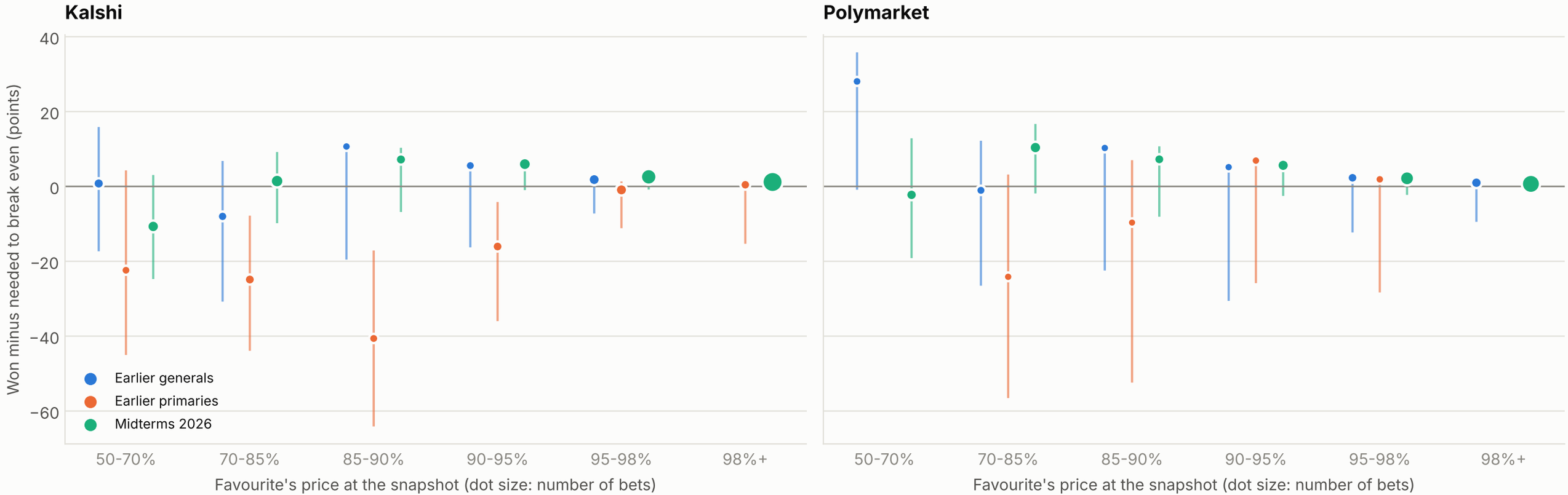Buying favourites, by price · midterms preliminary